

APPLICATION · STATE
STREET

DIGITAL ASSETS PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT LEAD,
AVP

Philipp Hilbert. *Digital assets product operator for institutional infrastructure.*

Positioning, ten years shipping complex financial software, now focused on the custody and settlement layer where tokenization meets institutional scale.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY STATE STREET

State Street Custody sits at the exact inflection point where distributed ledger infrastructure stops being experimental and starts being operationally required for asset managers and asset owners. The job description calls out tokenized funds, digital share classes, atomic DvP, and stablecoin settlement – these are precisely the workflows I have been mapping as a practitioner and product builder for years. State Street's global reach into insurance companies and official institutions means the surface area of that problem is serious, not sandbox. *That is exactly the scale where careful product thinking compounds.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My background in digital assets is deep on the user, protocol, and infrastructure side – eight years of hands-on crypto experience, strong command of DEX mechanics, custody models, and cross-chain risk – but I have not held a product role inside a custodian or prime broker. The transferable mechanic I bring is exactly what this role requires day-to-day: translating complex, ambiguous operational workflows into structured product requirements across regulated, multi-stakeholder delivery environments, which is what I have done at Rohde & Schwarz, the Federal Employment Agency, and Emil Group.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirement drafting and stakeholder document generation
 - **GPT**, research synthesis and competitive intelligence
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo coding assistance and spec validation
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, autonomous feature delivery and refactoring
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
 - **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing
 - **Gamma.app**, structured presentation and product narrative
 - **n8n**, multi-agent workflow orchestration
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, GitOps pipelines, Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CRYPTO BACKTESTING ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Algorithmic decision framework for digital asset market analysis, built from first principles.

- Ingests trade and order book data from centralized and decentralized venues including Hyperliquid and Bitget.
- Uses a file-queue-based agent loop architecture for modular signal generation and execution simulation.
- Incorporates liquidation heatmap data from Coinglass and Hyblock Capital to model market microstructure.
- Directly relevant to tokenized asset workflow analysis and the execution-quality thinking State Street needs for digital settlement products.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT STATE STREET

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow custody operations, compliance, and engineering stakeholders to map the current digital asset service pipeline – what exists, what is promised to clients, and where the handoffs between legacy and tokenized flows break down.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the roadmap.

Identify which initiatives on the existing roadmap have clear acceptance criteria and which are still operating on narrative rather than requirements, then propose a structured prioritization pass.

WEEK 3+

Ship the first slice.

Own one pilot-to-production workstream end-to-end, drive it through governance with a written business case, and establish the requirements and stakeholder cadence pattern the team can repeat.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

State Street Custody is making a bet that institutional asset servicing will increasingly run on distributed ledger infrastructure, and needs product people who can hold both worlds at once: the operational rigour of a regulated custodian and the technical literacy to make tokenized workflows actually ship. That combination is where I have spent the last several years.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a data management platform inside the European defence programme FCAS. The environment was multi-stakeholder, multinational, and regulated, with requirements that arrived incomplete and shifted under delivery pressure. I delivered autonomous feature sets from user story through GitOps rollout, cut deployment times from several days to under forty minutes, and unblocked infrastructure problems that had been sitting on the engineering backlog for over a year. The discipline required – translating

ambiguous operational needs into dev-ready specifications across business, engineering, QA, and compliance – is the same discipline digital asset product development at State Street demands.

At Emil Group I ran product for a B2B InsurTech platform where the selling proposition was collapsing insurance product time-to-market from over a year to under a week. That required understanding complex policy issuance and document management workflows in depth, rebuilding sprint discipline in a fragmented team, and re-establishing client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly workshops. The Claims Center module I delivered from concept to production rollout is a direct analogue to the kind of end-to-end feature ownership this role calls for.

On the digital assets side I bring eight years of hands-on experience across centralized and decentralized venues – custody models, DEX aggregation, perpetual mechanics, cross-chain bridging, oracle dependencies, and the stablecoin and settlement infrastructure that sits underneath all of it. I have studied market microstructure in detail, worked with liquidation analytics platforms, and built my own backtesting and agent framework in Python. This is not surface-level familiarity; it is the kind of practitioner knowledge that lets me read a smart contract specification, understand an MPC custody architecture, or interrogate a tokenized collateral workflow without needing it explained from first principles. The gap I acknowledge honestly is that I have not held a product role inside a custodian specifically – but the operational and regulatory complexity I have navigated at the Federal Employment Agency and Bundesdruckerei is directly comparable.

State Street's position – serving asset managers, insurance companies, and official institutions globally – means the stakes of getting digital asset product development right are structural, not experimental. I am drawn to that weight. I want to build product that institutional investors can rely on, not product that sits in a sandbox. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background maps to the specific pilots and roadmap priorities you are working on.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience turning complex operational workflows into scalable, regulated software systems. Background spans AI and data platforms, InsurTech SaaS, public-sector analytics, and defence-grade data infrastructure, consistently in cross-functional environments where requirements are incomplete and stakeholder alignment is hard-won. Brings eight years of hands-on crypto and DeFi experience including custody models, DEX

mechanics, stablecoin infrastructure, and cross-chain risk – combined with the delivery discipline to move digital asset initiatives from strategy through pilot to production inside large, governed organisations.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Translating ambiguous operational workflows into dev-ready product requirements
 - Pilot-to-production delivery in regulated, multi-stakeholder environments
 - Web3 and digital asset domain knowledge: custody, DEX, stablecoins, settlement
 - Cross-functional stakeholder alignment across engineering, compliance, and business
 - Backlog management, sprint discipline, and delivery velocity recovery
 - Business case development and competitive research for new product areas
 - AI-native product execution and rapid prototyping
 - Technical fluency across modern data, infrastructure, and API stacks
 - Founder-level pragmatism operating in ambiguous, evolving markets
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned a regulated, multinational data management platform end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation, testing, and GitOps-based rollout.
- Delivered audit trails with full data provenance and SafeAI / ExplainableAI transparency concepts – directly analogous to the compliance and traceability requirements of digital asset custody.
- Cut deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD.
- Unblocked infrastructure-level problems in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature that had been outstanding with the engineering team for over a year.
- Led cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA across multinational stakeholders.

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Advanced the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform, delivering labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling.
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes.
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage – experience directly applicable to KYC/KYB and transaction monitoring requirements in digital asset servicing.
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time.

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned product for a B2B platform collapsing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week, serving primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, brokers, and underwriters.
- Delivered Claims Center module from concept to production; also shipped product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, and document management modules.
- Rebuilt sprint discipline in a fragmented 17-person team: split into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, reduced senior developer attrition.
- Re-established client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops – governance experience relevant to State Street's complex stakeholder model.

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Built a mobile-first pilot app for hospitals across iOS and Android under tight deadlines and with legacy API constraints.
- Delivered digital anamnesis, therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage flows.
- Maintained stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity across CGM and hospital information system integrations.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

- **Qcrypt AG, Product Owner (2016–2018):** Quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware. Owned backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture. Also served as deputy IT security officer. Relevant to MPC/HSM custody controls and key management in digital asset infrastructure.
- **Kvitt Payment Solutions, Founder & CFO (2013–2018):** Group-based P2P payments on a P2P backbone. Owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype. Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.
- **Bundesdruckerei / RKI, Product Owner COVID-19 Data Platform (2021):** Secure data structures and identity management for RKI projects DIM and DESH. Regulated, high-stakes data environment.
- **AOK Health Insurance ITSCare, Proxy Product Owner (2019–2020):** Migration of internal webshop to Shopware with complex catalogue/API integration and customisable approval policies.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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